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conversion of leaf primordia into flower primordia under the influence of suitable inductive cycles is called **photoperiodic induction**. Example: *Xanthium* (SDP) – 1 inductive cycle and *Plantago* (LDP) – 25 inductive cycles.

3. Site of Photoinductive perception

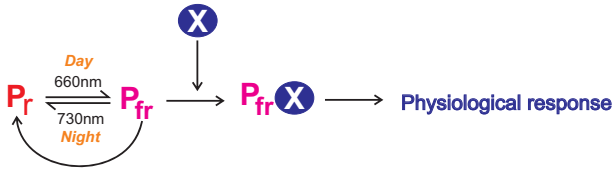
Photoperiodic stimulus is perceived by the leaves. Floral hormone is synthesised in leaves and translocated to the apical tip to promote flowering. This can be explained by a simple experiment on Cocklebur (*Xanthium pensylvanicum*), a short day plant. Usually *Xanthium* will flower under short day conditions. If the plant is defoliated and kept under short day conditions it will not flower. Flowering will occur even when all the leaves are removed except one leaf. If a cocklebur plant is defoliated and kept under long day conditions, it will not flower. If one of its leaves is exposed to short day condition and rest are in long day condition, flowering will occur (Figure 15.25).

The nature of flower producing stimulus has been elusive so far. It is believed by many physiologists that it is a hormone called **florigen**. The term florigen was coined by **Chailakyan** (1936) but it is not possible to isolate.

4. Importance of photoperiodism

1. The knowledge of photoperiodism plays an important role in hybridisation experiments.
2. Photoperiodism is an excellent example of physiological pre-conditioning that is using an external factor to induce physiological changes in the plant.

5. Phytochrome



Phytochrome is a bluish biliprotein pigment responsible for the perception of light in photo physiological process. **Butler *et al.*,** (1959) named this pigment and it exists in two interconvertible forms: (i) red light absorbing pigment which is designated as P_r and (ii) far red light absorbing pigment which is designated as P_{fr}. The P_r form absorbs red light in 660nm and changes to P_{fr}. The P_{fr} form absorbs far red light in 730nm and changes to P_r. The P_r form is biologically inactive and it is stable whereas P_{fr} form is biologically active and it is very unstable. In short day plants, P_r promotes flowering and P_{fr} inhibits the flowering whereas in long day plants flowering is promoted by P_{fr} and inhibited by P_r form. P_{fr} is always associated with hydrophobic area of membrane systems while P_r is found in diffused state in the cytoplasm. The interconversion of the two forms of phytochrome is mainly involved in flower induction and also additionally plays a role in seed germination and changes in membrane conformation.

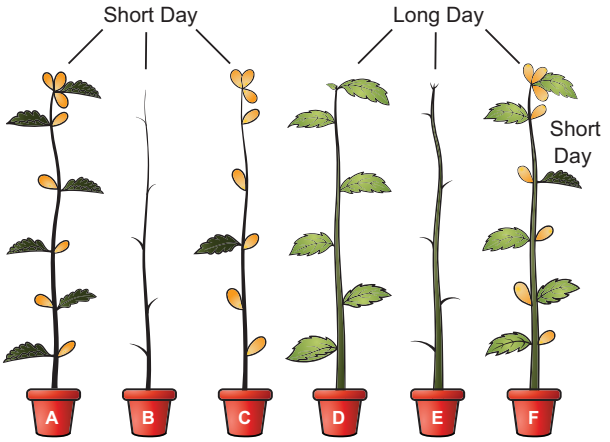


Figure 15.25: Experiment on Cocklebur plant showing photoperiodic stimulus